

Disenchanted of nature $\rightarrow$ De-centering of ^{centering} ~~the~~ divinity
 re?

Humanism → Subject of knowledge is the human

Every thing has history, and history is everywhere.

All of us are implicitly aware of our history

Every thing moves in time, with a past, ~~past~~ present and future.
The job of a historian is to make this awareness explicit.

History is not objective, it has no certitude, only levels of possibilities and degrees of probabilities.

Fact - Anything that is known or proved to be true information used as legal evidence, as a report or as news. Till recently, a fact was supposed to be the truth without interpretation.

Historia → enquiry / finding out (Greek)

Herodotus → ~~man~~ wrote on the history of wars b/w Greek and Persia. M.O. :- collect evidence, ask witnesses, build a systematic narrative of events

Thucydides → Peloponnesian Wars.

M.O.:- Evaluate evidence, neutral position, cause and effect

Realism:- Evaluate behaviours and outcomes without emotions and self-interest.

But by 1st century AD, fact based history was forgotten in favour of Revelation (Divine Will)

Ibn-e-Khaldun (1332-1406) :- Part of the Renaissance

Kitabe al-Ibar :- History of the world

Muqaddimah (Introduction) → Principles to evaluate evidence

Categorised errors and mistakes in historical investigation

↳ Partisanship, beliefs, lack of context, lack of knowledge

History is a new science to gain knowledge

Edward Gibbon (1737-1794) :- The History of the Decline and Fall of
The Roman Empire

Make distinction b/w Primary and Secondary Sources

Objectivity is the historian's aim.

Gave a secular history of Church and Christianity

Leopold von Ranke (1795-1886)

Just collect and present facts, no interpretation.

Only primary sources → interrogate the source (how, where, why) and build the credibility of facts

History of Catholic Popes:-

↳ tranquil and objective treatment

↳ without rancour, without enthusiasm

But facts are not value free. Facts do not exist outside of our seeing. Our act of seeing and recognising creates the facts.

Facts^{are} constituted by smaller antecedent facts, perspective, interpretation and assumptions (of facts)

What we see as facts depends on our perspectives

The facts that we select are determined by assumptions and interpretations, which in turn determines how we think.

Thus there is no neutral, objective fact, but it is instead an act, thing or event that is recognised only within the world of meaning created by humans

All facts are constituted by human actions. But facts do not have the same evidencing value as fiction.

Facts can be objective and impartial. It is possible to distinguish b/w fake, erroneous, facts and genuine facts.

Framing Questions:-

- (i) Who was involved
- (ii) What happened
- (iii) ~~What~~ When did it happen
- (iv) Where did it happen
- (v) How did it happen
- (vi) Why did it happen

Finding and Preserving facts

Evidence can be cross checked

Methods which can be scrutinised

Open and accessible standards of verifiability and falsifiability.

Facts change, importance of facts change and facts come and go.

False facts:- Historians often misread the meaning and intent of facts of the past.

There are always other interpretations that is likely

Deliberate Errors also exist (propaganda)

Past is (not) History:-

Past:- Time that ~~has~~ elapsed. Everything that occurred before the present. Is amorphous & hazy-all

History:- A narrative / story about something in the past, created by humans ^{using facts and protocols}. Has a beginning and an end and a common thread or anchor to the narrative.

Depends on what the historian wants to convey.

The historian chooses the time frame to suit their needs.

It is not possible to write a "meta-history"

Time period of History:-

History is the story of Human Society.

It is the story of civilisation

↳ Settled life

↳ Writing / Script

↳ Cities and States

Prehistory:- Society before civilisation

↳ Mobile life

↳ Oral Knowledge

↳ Rudimentary arts & creations

Historians always divide their narratives into periods.

↳ Pre history

↳ Ancient

↳ Medieval

↳ Modern

While widely used, historians do not prefer such distinctions

Based on the concept of time being an arrow, rather than as a cycle or a spiral.

Abrahamic Periodisation but Secularised

Common Markers of Historical Time

B.C. and A.D.

Before Christ Anno Domini (Year of our Lord)

Secularised to B.C.E. and C.E.

Before Common Era

Common Era

Circa c.

Approximate date.

There was no 0 A.D or 0 C.E

Decade - 10 years

Century - 100 years

Millennium - 1000 years

Historical Eras and Ages

i) Pre Historic Period:

① Stone Age :-

- i) Palaeolithic (from c. 2.5 mil BCE to c. 3000 BCE)
- ii) Mesolithic (from c. 25000 BCE to c. 2000 BCE)
- iii) Neolithic (from c. 10000 BCE to c. 500 BCE)

2) Historic Period:

(a) Chalcolithic Age

- i) From c. 3500 BCE to c. 1000 BCE
- ii) Indus Valley and beyond
- iii) Copper, Tin, Gold, etc.

(b) Bronze Age

- i) From c. 3000 BCE to c. 800 BCE
- ii) Indus Valley and Early Vedic

(c) Iron Age

- i) From c. 1000 BCE to c. 1000 BCE
- ii) Late Vedic and First Empires
- iii) Mastery over fire

(d) Ancient Period

- i) Indus Valley Civilisation
- ii) Vedic Age, Mahavira and Buddha
- iii) Mauryan, Saka and Hun, Kushan, Gupta Empires
Harshavardhan
- iv) Sangam Period, Cholas, Cheras, Pandyas, Satavahanas,
Chalukyas

(e) Medieval Period

(f) Modern Period

- i) 1757: Coming of the British - Battle of Plassey
- ii) 1764: Buxar
- iii) Mughals, Marathas, Mysore, Hyderabad all continued

But when do you draw the disicision between any two periods?

Technology? Education? Social Organization? Individualism?
Capitalism?

Regardless, these periods can be broken into Early, Middle and Late

Different regions and subregions have varying periods and eras

Problems with Periods

Universal Categories :- Ancient, Medieval and Modern

But history is specific, local. It is the history of a place, person, dynasty, event, process, etc.

Problem of Fit:- Different societies' ideas of periods might not align with other societies'. Even the time periods need not match.

Modern is often seen as a universal.

Historical Time

is super confusing

Beginning and End of Indus Valley = 2 millennia

But there were very likely multiple societies

Chronology is the spine of the Historical Narrative

↳ placing events in their order of occurrence in time

↳ Assumes an arrow of time

Hikasa:-

Myth of the eternal return

↳ Revealed, not rationally investigated

~~Shruti~~ Shruti:- Oral tradition, authoritative but authorless
↳ Vedas, Upanishads

Smriti:- Written, author known, derivative and inexact
↳ Mahabharata, Ramayana, Puranas etc.

Massive Cosmological ~~and~~ cycles, no diff b/w human & divine
Hikasa is predestined

No conceptual diff b/w past & future. Both are predestined.

Lokayat Tradition:-

Rejected predestination, or supernatural/divine.

Events caused by natural causes and human action

Knowledge can only be gained by perception & logic/reasoning.

A period of 700-1100 years, systematically eradicated

Charvach [Tsa'vak]

⊗ All this was found through hostile references.

Merged into itihasa/mythology

lives on in Family & Court Chronicles

Read Macaulay's Minutes on Education

Orientalists:-

Britishers [EIC] eager to study India's philosophies and histories.

Collected material artefacts, texts, oral traditions and customs.

Asiatick Society (1784, William Jones, Fort William, Calcutta)

↳ Indian members in 1808 → Asiatic Society Bombay in 1805

Dominant perspective till c. 1820

Liberals and Utilitarianism:-

James Mill, The History of British India, 1806-1817

↳ Never set foot in India, sources → orientalist reports claimed objectivity.

Thomas Babington Macaulay [1830]

↳ Minutes on Education → Oriental Traditions were pointless

↳ Discourage ancient teachings

↳ Teach them modern science & math (western) in English

↳ Indian Penal Code → Implemented in 1860

↳ One law for every person

Superstitions (example of bullets)

Argued that Indian society is British, Savage and Backwards

Moral mission of B English Rule → Civilise India

↳ Based on the vision of equality and liberty of (hu)man

British View :-

Periodisation :- Hindu, Muslim & British

All Ancient / Golden ← Tyranny / Dark Ages → Modern and progression

1857 → Revolt

- ↳ deep fear of Indians
- ↳ British racial superiority
- ↳ Indians beyond reform & civilisation

Conservative Liberalism → Liberals but do not take initiative to spread the "modern gospel"

Three axes of Indian History → Religion, Caste & Language

Milestones

- ↳ Discovery of Khavasthi and Brahmi
 - ↳ James Prinsep
 - ↳ Devanagari Piyadasi [Ashoka?]
- ↳ Archaeological Survey of India (1861)
- ↳ History depts in Calcutta & Bombay
 - ↳ Indology courses in western universities
- ↳ Rediscovery of Harappa & Mohenjodaro (1856-7; 1921-22)
- ↳ National Archives of India
 - ↳ Census (1872)
 - ↳ Land & Forest Settlement Reports
 - ↳ Imperial Records Dept (1891)
- ↳ Indian Historians
 - ↳ R.C. Dutt
 - ↳ Jadunath Sarkar

Main Schools

- ↳ British / Colonial
- ↳ Nationalist
- ↳ Marxist
- ↳ Subaltern

Differences:-

- ↳ Perspectives on history; what, how and why
- ↳ Methods; which sources, how to interpret

(i) British / Colonial

- ↳ Nothing that truly exists, geographical marker for the British.
- ↳ Too many disparities
- ↳ Each group, region & caste had differing histories

Identified Oriental Despotism and Village Communities

British Rule was the agent of change and unification

Claimed that Indians craved power not independence.
Self interest of "sedentary babus", not nationalism

(ii) Nationalist

- ↳ India had History and a Tradition of History writing.
- ↳ Great unifying empires
 - ↳ Ashoka, Gupta, Kushan, Mughals
- ↳ Unifying Ideologies
 - ↳ Vedas, Buddhism, Shankaracharya, Bhakti, Toleration
- ↳ Causes of conquest
 - ↳ British or Muslim $\Leftarrow$ Politricks
- ↳ Tried to write one Indian history

iii) Marxist

D.D. Kosambi

- ↳ History needs scientific tools
- ↳ Do not accept physical & literary sources at face value
- ↳ Look for material reasons $\Leftarrow$ class interests
- ↳ Question British Periodisation

R.S. Sharma et al

- ↳ economic & social foundations of Indian History
- ↳ focus on class struggle & role of common people
- ↳ freedom movement against all oppressors, not just British

iv) Subaltern:-

- ↳ Based on interpretation on Elite-Subaltern divide
 - ↳ Every source from the past was preserved by the Elite
 - ↳ Post-structuralist & Post-colonial outlook
- ↳ Take the Indigenous World view as the POV
 - ↳ All the other schools were of the elite and western
 - ↳ Western influence (British) was ^{a source of} epistemic violence
 - ↳ violence by knowledge
 - ↳ What did the masses believe, if they have left no records
- ↳ Focus on cultural history and psycho-social aspects of historical events
 - ↳ Read sources against the grain
- ↳ Emerged in India and spread through the world
 - ↳ 1981

The elite-subaltern divide was across all levels

Modern Indian History

New directions of studying environment, tech, Mentalité
Usage of computational tools
Oral histories gained importance
New Sources and Archives established

Some Historical Milestones

Indus Valley Civilization

Achhean Empire

Kushan Empire

Cholas

→ Not normal geographically

Mughal

British Raj

We think Cholas or captured territory, but Mughals
united/captured India. But both are false

River Basins sustain life, are self contained

They are historical units, divided by mountains, forests
and human artefacts

The Gangetic Plain is very fertile and kingdom there had
enough resources to feed and maintain armies. The tropical
climate of India is also an advantage.

hens & emperors included gods:

River valleys sustained stable agriculture, manufactured manufacturing, trade, cities & states.

Mountains are barriers to state formation

Think of the Hindi Belt, even that is on the Gangetic Plain even today!

Rivers, fields, forests and mountains:-

~~Agriculture~~ Agriculture and Industries result in conflicts b/w forests and fields, but this ~~is~~ has been going on for many years.

But there is also a complementary relationship b/w Forest & Field.

Interaction b/w the four and their subunits helped define India's past.

Movement & Stability:-

Populations grew only where all four are found together.
We have domesticated both plants and animals

↳ forms of grass ²⁵

Settled & nomadic populations → dialectic (polar groups interact)

All of these are both enabling & limiting conditions.

The Indus-Ganges valley was the centre of civilisation because of the

mastery of the horse, fire & iron

~~Civilization~~ in the ^M mountains are inhospitable to the state and civilization (Until 18th century)

There has been a long history of deforestation in the Gangetic plain.

The modern geography of the area is not natural, result of human activities.

Railways over turned the ~~are~~ importance of river valleys

New routes of trade and travel opening up

British did not depend on charcoal, used coal instead (Coal has a great ROI on energy)

British also brought along other technologies like census, (book keeping) cheap paper, cartography (with Trig)
↳ primary classification by religion and caste.

~~Form~~ Trigonometrical Survey (1802-1872)

Jambudweep :- India and the world.

Orient (verb) ← Move and fix something in line with the rising sun.